

Ἀνώνυμος ὑπόμνημα εἰς Ἀφθόνιον

Anonymous Commentary on Aphthonius and the Progymnasmatic Tradition

eul_aid: vng

Period: Ὀψιμαρχαία [Late Antique](#)
Dialect: Κοινή τεχνική [Technical Koine](#)
Domain: Ῥητορική [Oratory](#)
Format: Λόγος [Oration](#)
Affiliation: [Sophist](#)

The anonymous author of a commentary on Aphthonius was a teacher or scholar active in the 5th or 6th century CE during the late antique period. No personal details about their life are known. They worked within the Greek rhetorical education system of the Eastern Roman Empire, where the Progymnasmata, a textbook of preliminary exercises by Aphthonius of Antioch, was a standard work.

The author's primary surviving work is a line-by-line Commentary on Aphthonius, written to explain the textbook for students of oratory. A second set of explanatory notes, or scholia, on the same text is also attributed to the same anonymous tradition. Both works are preserved in manuscripts.

According to modern scholars, this commentary is a significant source for understanding how rhetoric was taught in late antiquity. It shows how a core textbook was interpreted in the classroom and provides technical explanations that might otherwise be lost. The work highlights the enduring importance of rhetorical exercises in Greek education and offers a view of teaching practices before the more famous Byzantine commentaries were written centuries later.

Works (2)

- [Προλεγόμενα εἰς Προγυμνάσματα](#) · [Prolegomena to Progymnasmata](#) · 8 passages
- [Προλεγόμενα εἰς Προγυμνάσματα ὑπὸ Ἀδήλου](#) · [Prolegomena to Progymnasmata by an Uncertain Author](#) · 13 passages

Other Sophist Authors

- [Ἀχιλλεὺς ὁ Τατίος ὁ Ἀλεξανδρεὺς](#) · [Achilles Tatius of Alexandria](#) · 1 work
- [Κλαύδιος Αἰλιανός](#) · [Aelian of Praeneste](#) · 4 works
- [Πόπλιος Αἴλιος Ἀριστείδης Θεόδωρος](#) · [Aelius Aristides of Smyrna](#) · 3 works
- [Αἴλιος Διονύσιος ὁ Ἀλικαρνασσεύς](#) · [Aelius Dionysius of Halicarnassus](#) · 1 work
- [Αἴλιος Θεών ὁ σοφιστής](#) · [Aelius Theon the Sophist](#) · 1 work
- [Ἀλκιδάμας ὁ Ἐλαεύς](#) · [Alcidamas of Elaea](#) · 1 work
- [Ἀλκίφρων ὁ Σοφιστής](#) · [Alciphron the Sophist](#) · 1 work
- [Ἀλέξανδρος ὁ τοῦ Νουμήνιου](#) · [Alexander Son of Numenius](#) · 2 works

- Ἀλέξανδρος ὁ Ἐφέσιος · Alexander the Ephesian Poet · 1 work
- Ἀμφικράτης Ἀθηναῖος · Amphicrates Atheniensis · 1 work
- Ἀντιφῶν ὁ Ἀθηναῖος · Antiphon of Athens · 9 works
- Ἀντιφῶν ὁ Ῥαμνούσιος · Antiphon of Rhamnus · 1 work